

India hits Pakistan in retaliatory strikes

Response to militant attack in Kashmir in April raises fears of war

This article is by Shaiq Hussain, Shams Irfan, Karishma Mehrotra, John Hudson and Maham Javid

ISLAMABAD, PAKISTAN — The Indian military said early Wednesday it had launched strikes against Pakistan in retaliation for last month's militant attack in Indian-administered Kashmir, putting the nuclear-armed neighbors in direct conflict for the first time in six years. India's armed forces said nine sites "from where terrorist attacks against India have been planned and directed" were targeted. The statement said no Pakistani military facilities were hit and characterized the attack as "focused, measured, and non-escalatory in nature."

But the strikes were swiftly condemned by Pakistan. Officials said eight people were killed, including a child and two teenagers, and 35 injured. "India has shamelessly attacked the civilian population, and the attack will be answered accordingly," Pakistani Defense Minister Khawaja Asif said on national television.

Prime Minister Shehbaz Sharif said in a statement that "Pakistan has every right to give a befitting reply to this act of war imposed by India and a befitting reply is being given."

Ahmed Sharif Chaudhry, Pakistan's chief military spokesman, told CNN that two Indian aircraft had been shot down by Pakistan. Soon after, Asif told Geo News that five Indian warplanes had been downed, including French-made Rafales. The claims could not be independently verified, and the Indian government had no immediate response.

Pakistan's military reported 24 "impacts" across six locations: Ahmedpur East, Muridke and Sialkot in Pakistan, and Kotli, Bagh and Muzaffarabad in Pakistani-administered Kashmir.

Faryal Waheed, 45, was getting ready for bed about 12:30 a.m. in the eastern Pakistani city of Bahawalpur when she heard four loud blasts in quick succession, she said. Her gatekeeper told her he had seen "huge flashes of light in the sky."

Waheed's husband, a general surgeon at Bahawalpur's biggest government hospital, was called in to work about 1 a.m., she said. SEE STRIKES ON A10

A beloved teacher fearing deportation bids farewell

As humanitarian parole expires, staying is a risk

BY KARINA ELWOOD

On the day before spring break at Forest Grove Elementary School in Northern Virginia, students bounded through the halls with backpacks swinging behind them. They wiggled in their seats, eager for vacation.

But in Jesús Rodríguez's music classroom, the mood was somber.

"Don't leave us!" one student shouted to Rodríguez after the class sang a medley. Other fourth- and fifth-graders wrapped their arms around one another, wiping tears from their eyes.

Rodríguez, a Venezuelan national, was legally living and working in this D.C. suburb under a humanitarian parole program that the Trump administration announced would end early. Without a clear path to stay legally, he decided to leave the United States, worried he could end up inside a Salvadoran prison — separated from his wife and 6-year-old daughter — if he didn't.

The departure of a beloved teacher at a Loudoun County school surrounded by cul-de-sac neighborhoods is just one example of how the policy changes

SEE TEACHER ON A6



LEA SUZUKI/SAN FRANCISCO CHRONICLE/AP

Tourists explore the old prison on Alcatraz Island on Monday. The national park in California attracts nearly 1.5 million visitors a year.

Prison proposal gets rocky response

In San Francisco, tourists and locals alike scoff at president's plan to make Alcatraz incarcerate again

BY LISA BONOS AND REIS THEBAULT

ALCATRAZ ISLAND, CALIF. — The barred cell doors are so rusted they can't close. Century-old lead paint is peeling off the walls. Concrete is crumbling, and the old rec yard is caked in seagull guano. This is no longer a fearsome prison. Not a working one, anyway.

Alcatraz the penitentiary shut down in 1963, but Alcatraz the

idea has lived on, a permanent part of the American mythology, a timeless symbol of ruthless and unforgiving incarceration. It's a potent image, inspired by tales of both fact and fiction, and it has captured the world's imagination — including, apparently, that of President Donald Trump.

To Trump, who in a social media post announced his intention to "REBUILD AND OPEN ALCATRAZ," the island is peak prison. "The ultimate," he said,

explaining his rationale to reporters.

But on "The Rock" — the nickname for this craggy piece of land a mile from the San Francisco waterfront — the president's proposal looked like a long shot. Visitors to the site, now a popular tourist attraction, said it seemed like an outlandish idea as they surveyed the prison's remaining buildings, all in varying states of disrepair. Locals took it as yet another attack on

the legendarily liberal city, long one of Trump's favorite punching bags. And elected officials treated it as both dangerous and distracting, vowing to either impede or ignore the plan.

"The chances of Alcatraz being repurposed as a prison are about as large as landing a man on Pluto," said Aaron Peskin, a former member of the San Francisco Board of Supervisors, who regularly swims in the frigid bay

SEE ALCATRAZ ON A2

Trump's focus flips from prosperity to austerity

BY NAFTALI BENDAVID

During his campaign and the early part of his current presidency, President Donald Trump promised an economic boom that would take off shortly after his return to the White House — reviving the American Dream and producing four years of unparalleled prosperity.

"Your paychecks will be higher, your streets will be safer and cleaner, your communities will be richer, and your future as an American will be much better than it ever has been when I get in," Trump said in his final cam-

paign rally, in Grand Rapids, Michigan. "Because this will be the golden age of America."

But Trump's tone, and that of his aides, has shifted notably in recent weeks, as they warn of sacrifice and "transition" until, by their telling, his heavy tariffs pave the way for a boom. Trump has spoken of the need to take economic "medicine," warned Americans they may need to cut back on items such as dolls and pencils, and suggested a short-

SEE AUSTERITY ON A15

Budget cuts: USDA program trims raise alarm for aid groups. A5



RICKY CARIOTI/THE WASHINGTON POST

First meeting for Carney and Trump

President Donald Trump met Tuesday at the White House with Canadian Prime Minister Mark Carney, who praised his U.S. counterpart but insisted Canada is "not for sale." Story, A4



HADLEY GREEN/THE WASHINGTON POST

Jesús Rodríguez, a music teacher, and his family decided to leave the United States for Spain.

U.S. urged Ukraine to accept deportees

BID INVOLVED OTHER COUNTRIES' CITIZENS

No sign war-torn nation seriously considered it

BY ADAM TAYLOR, SARAH BLASKEY AND SIOBHÁN O'GRADY

The Trump administration earlier this year urged the Ukrainian government to accept an unspecified number of U.S. deportees who are citizens of other countries, according to documents reviewed by The Washington Post, an extraordinary request of a nation at war and dependent on American military and financial support for its survival.

The documents do not indicate how officials in Kyiv responded to the late-January proposal, relayed by a senior U.S. diplomat, that called for sending third-country nationals to Ukraine amid Russia's deadly, devastating invasion — and despite the absence of a functioning airport there because of continual air attacks. A Ukrainian diplomat informed the U.S. Embassy only that her government would offer a response once it formulated a position, according to the documents, which show that similar proposals were issued to a number of other countries around the same date.

Ukraine has not accepted any third-party nationals from the United States, and there is no indication that Kyiv seriously considered the American proposal. Two Ukrainian officials familiar with the matter, who like some others spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss interactions

SEE UKRAINE ON A4

Houthi deal: Trump says U.S. will stop bombing rebels in Yemen. A10

Seeking records: Abrego García case prompts media inquiry. B6

Pick for top prosecutor in D.C. loses key GOP support

BY SPENCER S. HSU, PATRICK SVITEK AND PAUL KANE

Republican senators balked Tuesday at confirming Ed Martin before a key May 20 deadline, triggering a possible showdown with the White House over President Donald Trump's controversial pick for top federal prosecutor in D.C.

Sen. Thom Tillis (R-North Carolina) said he informed the White House that he opposed naming Trump's interim appointee to a full four-year term.

"If Mr. Martin were being put forth as a U.S. attorney for any district except the district where Jan. 6 happened, the protest happened, I'd probably support him," Tillis, who is up for reelection next year, told reporters. "But not in this district."

Tillis sits on the Senate Judiciary Committee, where Martin cannot afford to lose a single Republican vote. The senator has criticized the conservative lawyer's past support for nearly 400 Jan. 6, 2021, Capitol riot defendants charged with assaulting police officers, and who were among the nearly 1,600 riot participants

SEE MARTIN ON A16

IN THE NEWS

Germany's new chancellor The center-right Friedrich Merz initially failed to secure the needed parliamentary majority, raising doubts about his coalition's stability. A9

Cultural crossroads D.C.'s small but iconic Chinatown is facing pressure from outside and within amid a wave of development. B1

THE NATION The trial of officers who beat Tyre Nichols is a test of accountability efforts, observers said. A3 The Supreme Court allowed a ban on transgender troops to proceed as litigation continues. A7

THE WORLD In choosing a new pope, cardinals will call on a partner: the Holy Spirit. A8 Drone strikes on a military stronghold in Sudan hit targets including a key civilian airport. A11

THE ECONOMY Many big brands are backing away from Pride celebrations of all sizes, leaving event organizers with budget shortfalls. A12 The EPA plans to end the popular Energy Star program that helps consumers choose home appliances. A16

THE REGION The District's attorney general said Adolphe Edwards owes \$6.8 million in restitution after forcing tenants to live in unsafe conditions. B1 A former D.C. police officer convicted of prostituting teenage girls will be jailed while awaiting trial on new charges. B1

STYLE The Met Gala on Monday night was both counterprogramming and, in a delicious twist, a course correction. C1

FOOD Endurance athletes are turning to the humble potato as a carbohydrate-packed fuel source. E1

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